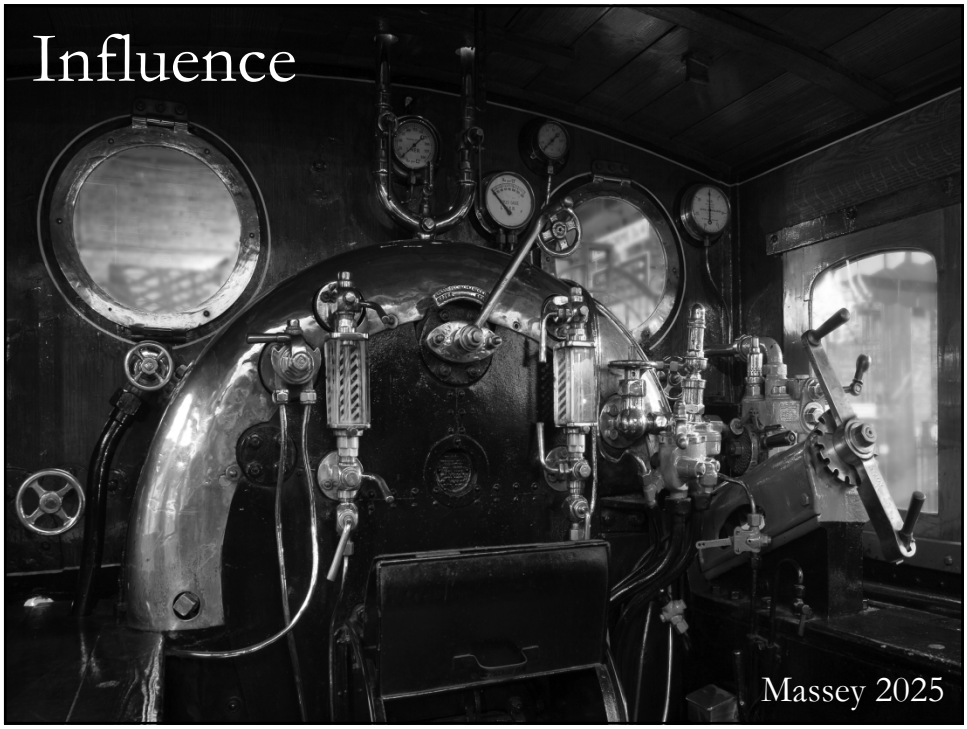


1

Course Admin

Wednesday: Ethics

- Vignette Survey
- Readings: Macchiavelli (The Prince), Banaji et al (HBR), Bhide & Stevenson (HBR)

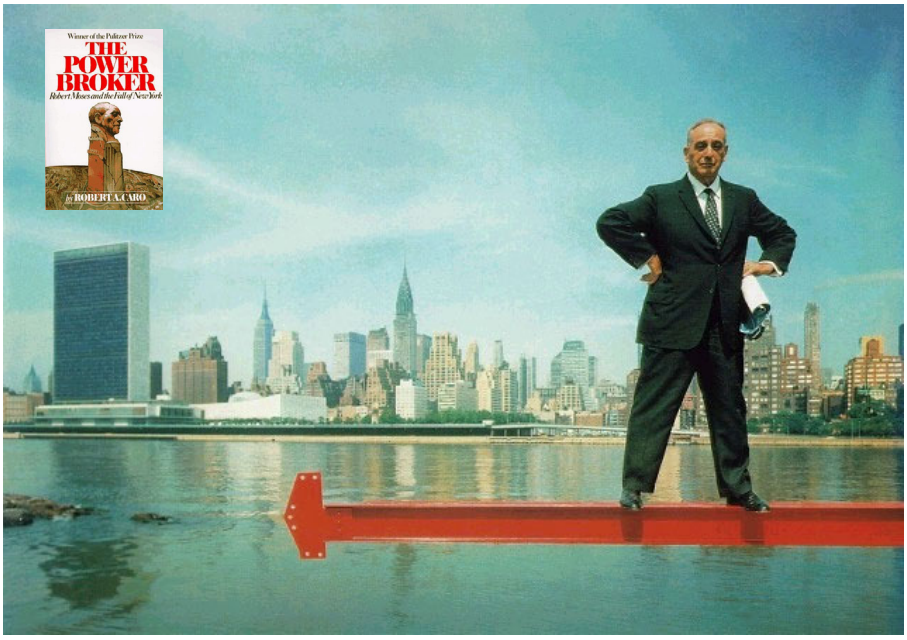
Persuasive Video

- 90-120 second, "Tell us about yourself"
- Record *in* the Qualtrics survey (super easy)
- Due midnight Friday
- Next week you'll evaluate each other

Leverage Inventory

- You received an email invitation Thursday (10/23)
- Invite up to 20 raters by midnight this Friday (10/31)

2

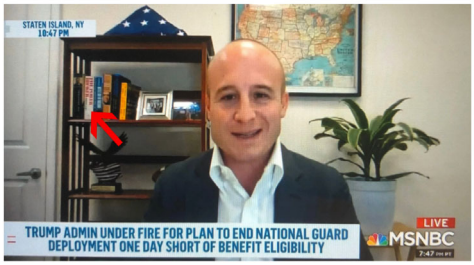


3

The New York Times

Lights. Camera. Makeup. And a Carefully Placed 1,246-Page Book.

'The Power Broker,' a biography by Robert Caro, has become a must-have prop for numerous politicians and reporters appearing on camera from home.



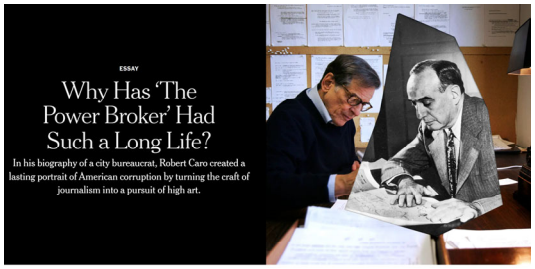
Representative Max Rose acknowledged intentionally placing the "The Power Broker" on his bookshelf, in camera view. The New York Times

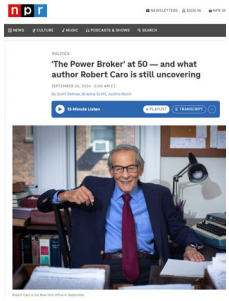
By Dana Rubinstein

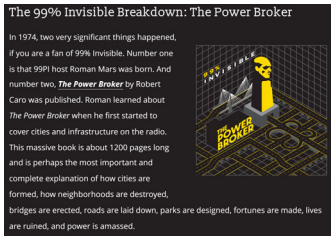
May 28, 2020

4

The Power Broker at 50 (Fall 2024)







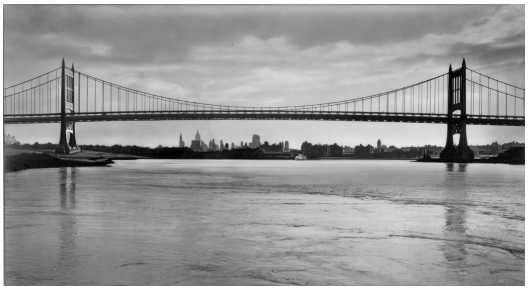


5

Triborough Bridge & Tunnel Authority

Public authority

- Independent borrowing authority
- Collects tolls on bridges it builds and manages
- Separate from state agencies, but still governed by the laws of New York State



6

Problems faced by Moses

He was bound by rules regarding personnel and contracting.

He was limited to building bridges and the roads leading to the bridges.

His bridges made <u>too much money!</u>

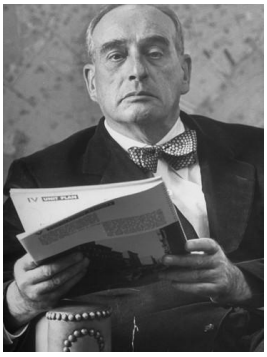
- As soon as the debt was paid off, the Public Authority would go away.



Changing the rules

Moses got the law regarding the powers of Authorities and nature of the bonds changed.

- Authority could retire and issue new bonds.
- Authority could build projects "not inconsistent" with the bridges.
- Authority was not bound by the civil service rules that applied to the government agencies.



The contract between Moses' Authority and debt holders is protected by the Constitution.

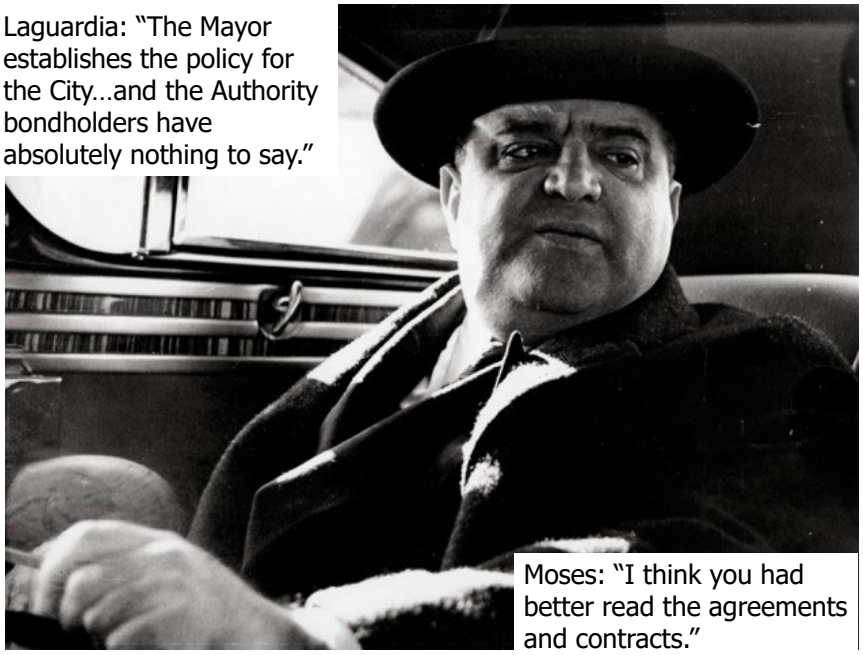
Changing the rules

Buried deep in the legislation, in a subdivision wholly unrelated to "Existence":

"The authority shall have power from time to time to refund any bonds by the issuance of new bonds, whether the bonds to be refunded have or have not matured, and may issue bonds partly to refund bonds then outstanding and partly for any other corporate purpose."

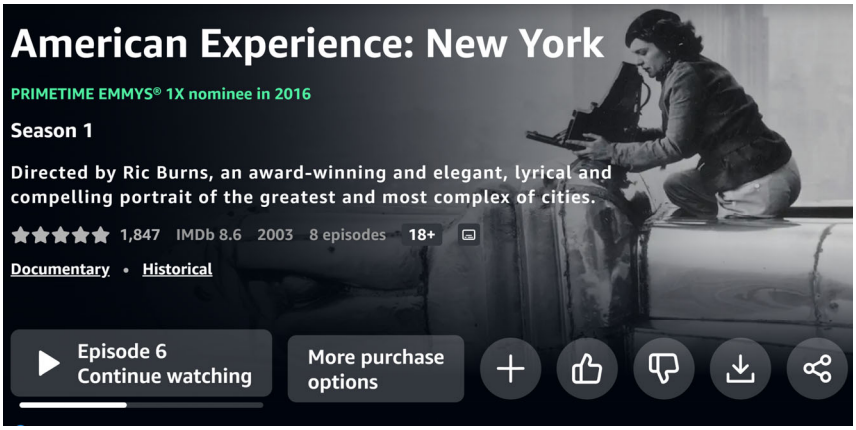
9

Laguardia: "The Mayor establishes the policy for the City…and the Authority bondholders have absolutely nothing to say."



Moses: "I think you had better read the agreements and contracts."

10



11

Moses take-aways (8:30, randomly selected)

Jerry Ren — One thing I took away from the Robert Moses reading was his ability to understand what factors he needed on his side to achieve the influence and goals he had bypass formal structures. An example is when he realized he could use revenue from his existing projects to capitalize new bonds. Rather than paying the bond off and surrendering his projects to the government, he created an indefinite funding cycle where he was able to hire a private planning and workforce rather than relying on the civil service. Through this, a major takeaway is the understanding where point A and point B is in the pursuit of power / your goal, and understanding what can give leverage

Brooke Perisho — It was a complete political mastery, sneaking in small amendments deep in bills and leveraging loopholes, to secure and cement his power. The reply to La Guardia was just absolutely savage; I was in awe.

Sammy Markowitz — Moses viewed limits to his power as movable impediments rather than firm guardrails, and creatively bypassed them without much negotiation.

Ryan Hager — Moses expanded his power toolkit (largely "Coercive") by seizing "Legitimate" power through someone with "Expert" power (bill drafter).

Tina Zhang — Moses used financial power to make himself independent from others' ruling, and he used areas of law to protect and defend his power

Christian Junewicz — One can find themselves in a position to leverage systems that turn short-term authority into productive and self-reinforcing power.

Alberto Falcone — Moses showed that real power isn't about titles, it's about controlling the systems that others must operate within.

Ben Newman — The cultivation of power in and of itself is neither ethical nor non-ethical; it is a tool.

12

Moses take-aways (10:15, randomly selected)

Hayden Manseau — One takeaway I had is that Robert Moses cultivated power by developing a likable external persona while simultaneously working behind the scenes to quietly build his power. He was great at spinning his achievements to seem to be in the public's best interest while privately having the goal of gaining more and more personal power. He was also masterful at deception, sneaking clauses into his bill that gave him powers that could not be rolled back.

Chris Allen — Robert Moses was a master at making his true motivations unknown and maintaining a public image of a true servant. Although extreme, it is a great example of how to use alliances and influence to plant seeds and gain trust while leading everyone to your ultimate goal without them knowing.

Olivia Sondler — Cultivating significant power is not predicated on formal appointment to a certain position. It can be acquired through unconventional means.

Ajay Reddy — Power built primarily via structure. Moses showed how controlling systems can outlast charisma but risk losing empathy and accountability.

Paula Fusaro Assis — Controlling money and rules/laws can be a major source of power and create a system of permanent authority.

Doris Wang — Power can be driven by controlling resources rather than holding certain positions (e.g., office)

Nicole Cavett — Sometimes it is necessary to use coercive power to wield influence.

13

Moses take-aways (1:45, randomly selected)

Andrew Carton — I found Robert Moses' ability to codify his power fascinating. By weaving in seemingly innocuous clauses into documents and then ensuring those clauses made their way into bond contracts, he ensured no one could revoke his power. While the bases of social power we discussed last class are influential, I believe this reading suggests there are few sources as valuable as contractually binding power: you may not like it, but there's very little you can do about it.

Peter Vosbikian — Moses uses opacity to his advantage when augmenting his power. He took several independent measures that at face value seemed insignificant and confusing, but when stacked together radically increased and preserved his authority.

Brian Gerevits — Cultivating image is a key factor in developing power. Moses was able to do this by shaping an institution in to mirror his own public image.

Prem Patel — Real power lasts when it's built into systems and rules, not just tied to personal authority or short-term influence.

Andrea Delgado — Moses identified the most important point of leverage, money, and became an expert at using it to influence others

Saup Mazumdar — Power comes from building a reputation. In his case, he was good with numbers and estimates.

Thomas Kielmanowicz — Ability to sneakily craft and pass legislation to serve his interests.

Nicole Qin — Careless preparation can make you lose control before you realize.

14

Where did Moses' power come from?

The Bases of Social Power

French & Raven's classic model

- Reward Power ✓
- Coercive Power ✓
- Expert Power ✓✓✓
- Referent Power ✓
- Legitimate Power ✓

Massey — Influence

15



16

JSK as NYC Transport Commish ('07-'13)

Some of JSK's accomplishments in NYC

- >60 pedestrian plazas in all 5 boroughs
- Repurposed >40 acres of active car lanes
- 350 miles of on-street bike lanes
- 1st parking-protected bike lane in the U.S.
- 6,000-bike bike-share program (now 12,000)
- # of cyclists >2x
- 57 miles of dedicated speedy bus lanes

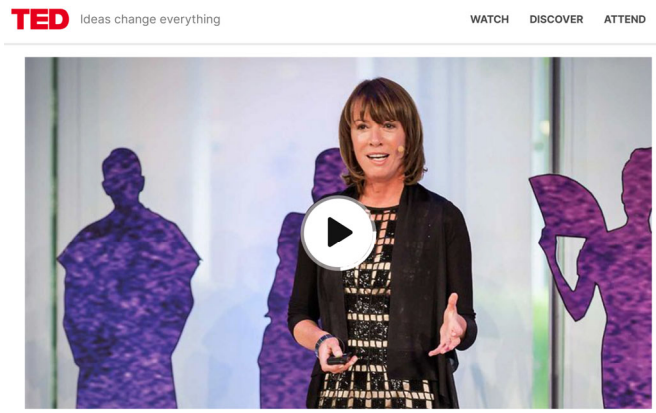
Ideas emulated around U.S. and internationally

17

JSK's Times Square



18



19

JSK take-aways (8:30, randomly selected)

Dan Kanef — Sadik-Kahn did a great job of building connections across the city to build political capital to start the Times Square project. She met with the hospitality industry, theater groups, etc. to build awareness and get people involved in her project so at least they could start a pilot of it. Eventually this paid off - her hospitality contact, Tim, was able to bring chairs to the plaza quickly and cheaply. The chairs made the Times Square plaza a true pedestrian success and memorable NYC moment.

Roya Dadgar — Appealing to authority and gaining buy-in from the community were Sadik-Kahn's main tools for cultivating and using power. She primarily used her own expert power.

Tiffany Yuan — Identifying what values someone who can confer power to you holds (e.g. data for Bloomberg) can be a powerful tool for cultivating legitimate power

Divya Ravinder — You can only gain / keep power if people like or respect you. Despite improving NYC's safety, Janette lost hers by treating others poorly.

Dveer Ofer — Sometimes data and clear design can be powerful tools, especially when you can show tangible results. But it is a very risky approach.

Steve Berkowitz — Her focus on "intellectualism" ("I know best") to problems created adversaries that overshadowed her achievements within transport.

Rachel Prokupek — Testing a solution in 1 area to prove effectiveness and build trust before expanding the plan was successful.

Riley Nolan — Smart and innovative do not make up for brash and abrasive

20

JSK take-aways (10:15, randomly selected)

Alexia Hernandez — One thing I learned is experimentation is key to testing hypotheses and trying something on a smaller scale before expanding it. Also using your power to benefit people's real issues like traffic death is a good use of power and doing so independent of a political calendar is also admirable. Another aspect is communicating directly with stakeholders about your plan to steer the media's narrative and communicate your vision.

Josh Klein — Experimentation and data are very important when selling a large scale project. It also helps that Bloomberg is data driven. Slow experimentation helped win over the public without being overwhelmed with backlash all at once.

Carolina Nakamura Chapuis — Sometimes using power already developed to try something new is worth it, if you have the baggage to sustain your power. But be careful with the promises made (under promise and overdeliver).

Saawan Patel — Similar to Moses, she cultivated power by being the person who get's the job done. Despite her abrasiveness, she was in a formal position of power due to her abilities.

Panpan Jriyasetapong — The best way to influence other people is to reframe the situation, show proof and results, not use force so it will be more sustain.

Arielle Flynn — Power comes from action, using data, design, and persistence to turn ideas into visible change people can't ignore.

Rishika Ranka — Real power lies in pushing bold ideas that make cities more livable, even when there's resistance.

21

JSK take-aways (1:45, randomly selected)

Pawin Kauphanichanon — There's a fine line around being liked and being effective. Whatever you do there's always/most likely going to be someone would not like it therefore, however, you can also choose to be effective and display empathy as you cultivate power. Going full effective or empathetic may not be the right course of action to evoke change.

Louis Van De Ven — The stark contrast of her point of view ("To get things done you have to charge ahead and can't get everyone's buy-in") and the 3rd party POV ("She achieved a lot but a of people hate her") stood out to me - I'm not sure whether this is a good or bad use of power and have complicated thoughts on it.

Leigh Steinberg — Sadik-Kahn's unapologetic attitude was my biggest takeaway. Unlike Moses, who cared deeply about his positive public image, she gained power through direct confrontations without concern for her image.

Aurian Capart — Sadik-Kahn shares her "get it done" ethos with Moses, but wasn't able to capitalize on it like he did. While he kept increasing his power, she slowly had to surrender to the reality of government.

Sarah Gurbach — Proposing an "experiment" is an easier way to get to yes. Including multi-disciplinary stakeholders makes them feel more included and likely to support new ideas

Samuel Tedori — She showed that testing ideas and letting data speak can catalyze government action and shift public opinion faster than debate alone.

Gabby Sirazi — True power comes from courage and trying new ideas despite risk. Progress only happens with leaders dare to act.

Andrew Herbst — I really liked the quote mentioning if you're not constantly trying new things, you're not trying hard enough

22

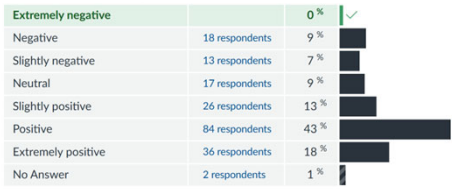
Reactions to Moses and JSK (via survey)

Do you consider this Robert Moses take-away to be negative or positive (i.e., something to avoid or to emulate)?



Extremely negative	4 respondents	2 %
Negative	32 respondents	16 %
Slightly negative	29 respondents	15 %
Neutral	27 respondents	14 %
Slightly positive	48 respondents	24 %
Positive	42 respondents	21 %
Extremely positive	11 respondents	6 %
No Answer	3 respondents	2 %

Do you consider this Janette Sadik-Kahn take-away to be negative or positive (i.e., something to avoid or to emulate)?



Extremely negative		0 %
Negative	18 respondents	9 %
Slightly negative	13 respondents	7 %
Neutral	17 respondents	9 %
Slightly positive	26 respondents	13 %
Positive	84 respondents	43 %
Extremely positive	36 respondents	18 %
No Answer	2 respondents	1 %

23

Breakout Groups

What do we learn about building and keeping power from looking at Moses & JSK side by side? What is one lesson you take-away?

24

Overall, a few themes that jump out…

Performance
Image
Organizational processes
Agency
Ethics

The critical role of performance

Moses had access to the levers of power only because of a reputation for performance built over decades.

- The "Man Who Got Things Done"

Expert power

- Having a niche helps

But image matters (like it or not)

Even with his abilities and power, Moses still worried continuously about his image

JSK is not your typical bureaucrat

- "charm", "beguiling", "good at a cocktail party"

But image matters (like it or not)

Perhaps the most important aspect of your image is that you are successful

- "People's support for you will depend as much on whether or not you seem to be "winning" as on your charm and ability (p88)
- The seems to be the case even with JSK
  - Compare New York 2009 & Esquire 2010 with New York Times 2011.

Navigating Image (aka Person Perception)

In order to change the world, we must first understand the world, in all its imperfections.

- E.g., was JSK perceived differently than Moses, in the same role, because of her gender?

Psychology has much to tell us about how we tend to perceive others, and how they perceive us.

Understanding leads to tips for navigating.

Navigating Stereotypes

Journal of Applied Psychology
2007, Vol. 92, No. 1, 81–92

Copyright 2007 by the American Psychological Association
0021-9010/07/$12.00 DOI: 10.1037/0021-9010.92.1.81

Why Are Women Penalized for Success at Male Tasks?:
The Implied Communality Deficit

Madeline E. Heilman
New York University

Tyler G. Okimoto
Flinders University of South Australia

Available online at www.sciencedirect.com
SciVerse ScienceDirect
ELSEVIER
RESEARCH IN ORGANIZATIONAL BEHAVIOR
Research in Organizational Behavior 32 (2012) 113–135

Gender stereotypes and workplace bias

Madeline E. Heilman
Department of Psychology, 6 Washington Place, room 551, New York, NY 10003, United States

Available online 21 November 2012

Heilman's summary

Social psychological foundations:

- Stereotypes are category-based expectations
  - Think: Reasoning by social category
- The overarching male stereotype is agentic.
- The overarching female stereotype is communal.

In organizations…

- The stereotype of an organizational leader is male.
- Therefore a woman doesn't "fit" as a leader.
- Consequently people expect poor performance from her.
- If her performance is ambiguous, it will be construed to be consistent with expectations (i.e., poor).
- If performance is unambiguously good, she will be construed to be not female (i.e., not communal).

Navigating stereotypes (Heilman & Okimoto 2007)

Women in stereotypically male jobs must be unambiguously good at their job (b/c they're judged more harshly) AND flash credentials as communal (else be counter-stereotyped as a b****).

Analogously: Men in stereotypically female jobs must be unambiguously good AND flash credentials as agentic (else be counter-stereotyped as as wimp).

Navigating stereotypes

General prescription (following Heilman & Okimoto): If you believe others' expectations of you are adversely affecting you, you need to find ways to defy them.

E.g., a former (Black) student, who played college basketball, actively chose against playing in his company's basketball league in order to mitigate others' stereotypes of him.

Note: This is clearly unfair, and a burden. It is also counter-productive for organizations. As managers and leaders we should work to mitigate. As individuals this is the situation we face at this moment.

Framework: "Optimal Differentiation"

If you're **similar** on all dimensions what value do you add?

- Coco Chanel: "In order to be invaluable you have to be different"

But if you're **different** on all dimensions it's tough to get traction

Most influential is some blend of similarities and differences

=> You don't have to share all dimensions, but you need to share some.

Fighting Stereotypes

Blinding

- Find ways to evaluate work/qualifications free from identities and social categories
- "Judge the music, not the musician"

Populate "the room" differently

- A homogenous decision-making body will more likely stumble over these biases
- Broaden representation when hiring, allocating resources, building programs, etc.

Level the informal playing field, also

- Relationships are built, and therefore opportunity conferred, over drinks, dinner, golf, exercise, etc.
- Takes intention to overcome inertia here.

The informal playing field, an example

An application from a WEMBA student, Fall 2022:

The best hire I ever made was an analyst manager I poached as I was leaving Blue Shield of California. I had only ever worked with him formally a couple times. But we had smoked about 1,000 cigarettes together in the ever shrinking smoking zone behind the office. And while smoking we talked about the company, about the people, and the drama.

Sometimes we helped each other out. Often it was simple little things: department X is actually sitting on data that would solve your headache they are just too paranoid to tell anyone. Sometimes it was more clandestine: if director X gives you any more trouble ask VP Y what you should do. I happen to know VP Y has warned director X many times about their attitude toward subordinates and your problem will magically disappear. Through it all I came to think of this analyst manager as both competent, and trustworthy.

When I left the company for my first director role he was my first hire, and it took a 5 minute conversation in the parking lot on my last day to convince him to leave. He's been my highly effective lieutenant ever since.

Overall, a few themes that jump out…

Performance
Image
Organizational processes
Agency
Ethics

Power of organizational process/structure

"It is often the case that exercising power creates enemies who constitute a threat to your long-term organizational survival. Thus, in developing and exercising power it is important to use structural mechanisms that institutionalize your power and diffuse responsibility for decisions and actions."

- Pfeffer 1992, p274

Organizational Process

Given the nature of rules & structure, what are the implications for you as a manager?

- Recognize they are not always established in the best interest of the organization
  - Allison's famous analysis of the Cuban Missile Crisis
  - Private agendas, competing interests, benign neglect, etc.
- Do not accept them as a given
  - These are essentially cards that are dealt and re-dealt continuously – you can (and should!) influence the dealing

The importance of agency

Def: To act; to exert control over one's environment.

Course examples already

- Moses writing new legislation (surreptitiously)
- JSK working outside the bureaucracy
- Reginal Lewis (Pfeffer p76) – Harvard law
- Sergio's "Timorization" process
- (Fire analyst) Mitch's challenge moving outside formal channels

The importance of agency

"Rule-breakers" are essential for innovation (Canales)

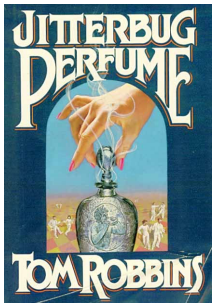
Pfeffer: "So, if you have all the power you want or need, by all means not only follow the rules but encourage everyone else to do so too. But if you are still traversing your path to power, take all this conventional wisdom and "rule following" with a big grain of salt." (p86)



"I don't want to be a product of my environment. I want my environment to be a product of me."

–Frank Costello, The Departed

The importance of agency



"The gods have a great sense of humor, don't they? If you lack the iron and the fizz to take control of your own life, if you insist on leaving your fate to the gods, then the gods will repay your weakness by having a grin or two at your expense. Should you fail to pilot your own ship, don't be surprised at what inappropriate port you find yourself docked. The dull and prosaic will be granted adventures that will dice their central nervous systems like an onion, romantic dreamers will end up in the rope yard.

"You may protest that it is too much to ask of an uneducated fifteen-year-old girl that she defy her family, her society, her weighty cultural and religious heritage in order to pursue a dream that she doesn't really understand. Of course it is asking too much. The price of self-destiny is never cheap, and in certain situations it is unthinkable. But to achieve the marvelous, it is precisely the unthinkable that must be thought."

The importance of agency

A vital characteristic of powerful people is their actively shaping the situations they face, rather than passively accepting what they find.

This is "stacking the deck" rather than "playing the cards you're dealt."

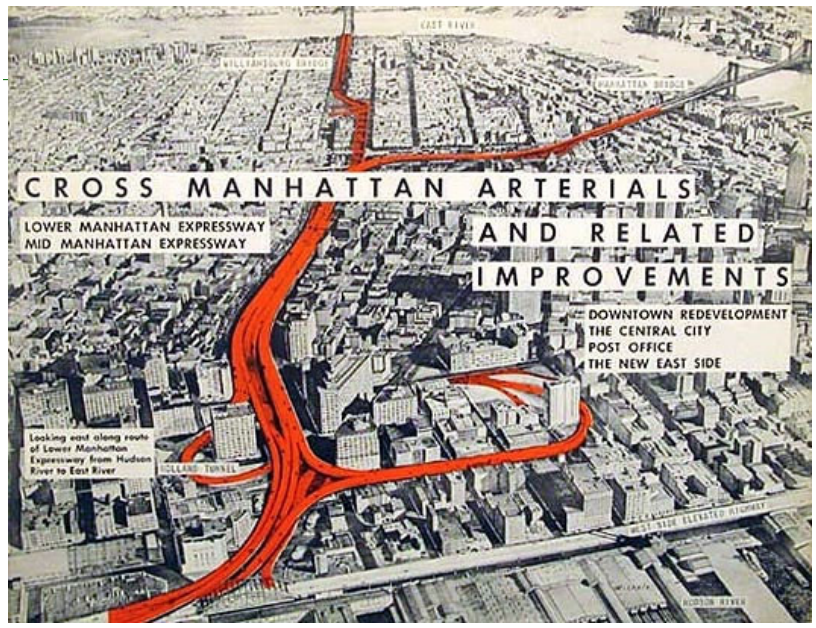
Influence & Ethics

The cultivation and use of power is inextricably linked with ethics.

Influence & Ethics

JSK "has an absolute certainty that she is correct."

"Robert Moses himself was certain he held the keys to the city's future."



Influence & Ethics

The end cannot justify the means, for the simple and obvious reason that the means employed determine the nature of the ends.

- Aldous Huxley

If the end doesn't justify the means, what does?

- Robert Moses

Some takeaways from Moses & JSK

Performance is the foundation of power.

Robust power is multiple.

Robust power accretes.

The profound, but often hidden, power of organizational processes.

Ethical issues are intimately intertwined with the cultivation and use of power

49